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YC Application (Spring 2025)

Founders

Erik Hancock Profile complete [Edit profile →](#)[+ Add a co-founder](#)

Who writes code, or does other technical work on your product? Was any of it done by a non-founder? Please explain.

I, Erik, do all the technical work.
I have developed this product set over the past 13 years.

Are you looking for a cofounder?

Yes

Founder Video

Please record a one minute video introducing the founder(s).*

Make sure the file does not exceed 100 MB. Read more about the video [here](#).

↓
Drop here or browse

Company

Company name*

ActiveShield [Medical]

Describe what your company does in 50 characters or less.*

Deactivate viruses and odors before they escape.

Company URL, if any

https://www.activeshieldmedical.com/

If you have a demo, attach it below.

Anything that shows us how the product works. Please limit to 3 minutes / 100 MB.

↓
Drop here or browse

Please provide a link to the product, if any.

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ltw8DpCrynp4tRMKGQ77p7g€

If login credentials are required for the link above, enter them here.

username / password

What is your company going to make? Please describe your product and what it does or will do.

We place an ozone generator in-line with the exhaust vent to deactivate the odor before it leaves the facility. In facilities with central HVAC, we install an in-line ozone generator inside the return. Our in-line ozone generator then deactivates / removes the noxious odor before it is vented into the atmosphere. Or, before the noxious odor enters the air conditioning unit. We further offer ozone destruct devices installed in sequence following our ozone generator to make the newly purified by

Where do you live now, and where would the company be based after YC?

Use the format City A, Country A / City B, Country B

Lucerne, CA, USA / San Francisco, CA, USA

Explain your decision regarding location.

San Francisco offers the nearest, best access to channels of distribution, ports of travel, and business entities.

Progress

How far along are you?

We are on our fifth prototype mask MVP.
We have recently reached a partnership agreement with Ozone Solutions | 451 Black Forest Rd Hull, IA 51239 | (281) 671-0300 | <https://ozonesolutions.com/> to install their tech, as per our plans.

How long have each of you been working on this? How much of that has been full-time? Please explain.

I have been working on this for the past 13 years.
I have been working on this full-time for only the past 12 months.

What tech stack are you using, or planning to use, to build this product?

I have partnered with Ozone Solutions | 451 Black Forest Rd Hull, IA 51239 | (281) 671-0300 | <https://ozonesolutions.com/> to install their systems as part of my patentable process.

Are people using your product?

Yes

No

How many active users or customers do you have? How many are paying? Who is paying you

the most, and how much do they pay you?

Two active users, my wife and me.
No one is paying.

Do you have revenue?

Yes

No

If you are applying with the same idea as a previous batch, did anything change? If you applied with a different idea, why did you pivot and what did you learn from the last idea?

With this current application, I have pivoted from an MVP of wearable tech to an MVP of installing my system(s) in commercial facilities. I will additionally produce filters for battlefield breathing in chemically and biologically contaminated environments.

If you have already participated or committed to participate in an incubator, "accelerator" or "pre-accelerator" program, please tell us about it.

N/A

Idea**Why did you pick this idea to work on? Do you have domain expertise in this area? How do you know people need what you're making?**

I found this idea when attempting to emulate Ozonics hunting technology. When Ozonics released their MVP, I too began hunting with an ozone generator to actively mask my scent. However, I built my ozone generator to vent the inside of my ground blind to the outside. To accomplish, I included a chimney to be zipped into the top of my ground blind. When hunting in this manner, I felt invisible to the deer.

Who are your competitors? What do you understand about your business that they don't?

- I. PathogenFocus 880 Facet Road | Henderson, NC 27537 | 1-866-883-6287 | <https://pathogenfocus.com/> ;
- II. Ozone Solutions | 451 Black Forest Rd Hull, IA 51239 | (281) 671-0300 | <https://ozonesolutions.com/> ;
- III. Ozonics | 520 S Pierce Ave Suite 216 Mason City, IA 50401 | (979) 285-2401 | <http://>

How do or will you make money? How much could you make?

(We realize you can't know precisely, but give your best estimate)

We will make money by building profit into our installation fees.
We will make money as well by installing the electrical components on a subscription-only basis, including the ozone generator and ozone destruct devices.

Which category best applies to your company?

Hard Tech



You're being asked the following questions because you selected the category Hard Tech.

Please describe the scientific basis for your product. How does it work?

(It's best if you address your answer to a scientist, but one who is not a specialist in your field)

Our product's ozone's chemical oxidizing power is primarily responsible for our pathogen and odor elimination.
Oxidative Damage via Ozone and ROS:
Impact on Viral Pathogens: Viral pathogens are mainly inactivated by the oxidative effects of ozone and other reactive species produced in the generator. Ozone oxidizes proteins and lipids in the viral

Describe the next few stages in developing your product. For each stage, how much time and money will it take?

?

If you were accepted into YC, what could you accomplish by Demo Day?

?

Does your product need regulatory approval (i.e., FDA)? If so, what is the approval process? What is your plan to get approved, and how much time and money will it take?

The wearable PPE would require FDA approval.
Retain our FDA specialist, in conjunction with a design engineering firm, to develop a product capable of receiving FDA approval. Our FDA specialist is: Mark Paxton | White Oak Law | 117 Classic Court Versailles, KY 40383 | <https://www.whiteoakailaw.com/> .

What experimental data (if any) do you have showing that this would work?

If you would respectfully please see the video in the link below? It is of a whitetail buck 40 yards downwind of me that failed to detect my presence while wearing the mask. This failure to detect an ultimately lethal threat due to my wearing our product mask, shows the effectiveness of our mask's odor destroying capabilities. ChatGPT opines that ours will equally destroy/deactivate airborne viruses: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1mkZYbPadKkle4E2c3mnz2u-irfi_7wcw/view?usp=sharing.

If you had any other ideas you considered applying with, please list them. One may be something we've been waiting for. Often when we fund people it's to do something they list here and not in the main application.

Other Ideas Listed:

1. Wearable PPE to prevent the spread of respiratory acquired infections.
 - a. A mask containing an AFV (ozone generator) behind an anti-backflow valve. Our wearable Active Virus Filter (AFV) technology prevents 99.9% of viral load from escaping the wearer, thereby protecting those around them from respiratory Healthcare Acquired Infections (HAI's). Our AFV

Equity

Have you formed ANY legal entity yet?

This may be in the US, in your home country or in another country.

Yes

No

If you have not formed the company yet, describe the planned equity ownership breakdown among the founders, employees and any other proposed stockholders. If there are multiple founders, be sure to give the proposed equity ownership of each founder and founder title (e.g. CEO). (This question is as much for you as us.)

As the principal founder, I will own 60% of the company
When I have another co-founder, I will offer them 40%.
As other people join,
I will carve out equity for them as well.

Have you taken any investment yet?

Yes

No

Are you currently fundraising?

Yes

No

Please provide any relevant details about your current fundraise.

I recently called or emailed five (5) VC's.
I have received no replies.

Curious

What convinced you to apply to Y Combinator? Did someone encourage you to apply? Have you been to any YC events?

When searching for financial advice on the internet, many of the resources I discovered. Pointed towards investing in my own startup(s) as a means of accelerating gains. While designing these items, monetization has always occurred. My somewhat recent introduction to X/twitter has really given me anecdotal motivation to apply to YC. However, once I had YC narrowed down, YCs' own YouTube videos greatly facilitated my application.

How did you hear about Y Combinator?

Popular media.

! Founder video is required

After submitting your application, you will be able to edit only certain sections: founder profiles, founder video, demo video, progress, and fundraising.

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